```
id: "1"
created_at: 2008-09-05 22:55:47
attributes_cache: {}

Title: Rails debugging guide
```

1.3 inspect

Another useful method for displaying object values is `inspect`, especially when working with arrays or hashes. This will print the object value as a string. For example:

```
<%= [1, 2, 3, 4, 5].inspect %>
<p>
  <b>Title:</b>
  <%= @article.title %>
</p>
```

Will be rendered as follows:

```
[1, 2, 3, 4, 5]

Title: Rails debugging guide
```

2 The Logger

It can also be useful to save information to log files at runtime. Rails maintains a separate log file for each runtime environment.

2.1 What is the Logger?

Rails makes use of the `ActiveSupport::Logger` class to write log information. You can also substitute another logger such as `Log4r` if you wish.

You can specify an alternative logger in your `environment.rb` or any environment file:

```
Rails.logger = Logger.new(STDOUT)
Rails.logger = Log4r::Logger.new("Application Log")
```

Or in the `Initializer` section, add *any* of the following

```
config.logger = Logger.new(STDOUT)
config.logger = Log4r::Logger.new("Application Log")
```

By default, each log is created under `Rails.root/log/` and the log file is named after the environment in which the application is running.

2.2 Log Levels

When something is logged it's printed into the corresponding log if the log level of the message is equal or higher than the configured log level. If you want to know the current log level you can call the`Rails.logger.level` method.

The available log levels are: `:debug`, `:info`, `:warn`, `:error`, `:fatal`, and `:unknown`, corresponding to the log level numbers from 0 up to 5 respectively. To change the default log level, use

```
config.log_level = :warn # In any environment initializer, or
Rails.logger.level = 0 # at any time
```

This is useful when you want to log under development or staging, but you don't want to flood your production log with unnecessary information.

The default Rails log level is `debug` in all environments.

2.3 Sending Messages